

Jacob Hazen

Department of Economics, McGill University, Leacock Building, 855 Sherbrooke St W, Montreal, QC
H3A 2T7

jacobhazen1.github.io | jacob.hazen@mcgill.ca

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics 2022 – Expected April 2027

McGill University

Advisors: Prof. Fabian Lange and Prof. Fernando Saltiel

M.A. in Economics, Specialization in Data Science (Thesis) 2020 – 2022

Carleton University

Advisor: Prof. Ba Chu

B.A. in Economics, Minor in Computer Science 2016 – 2020

University of Calgary

RESEARCH AND TEACHING INTERESTS

Primary: Labor Economics, Applied Microeconomics

Secondary: Applied Econometrics, Economics of Education

JOB MARKET PAPER

“It’s More Than Time and Money: How the Parent-Child Relationship Shapes Skill Formation” Oct 2026

Abstract: I study how the parent–child relationship shapes the development of children’s socio-emotional skill. I develop and estimate a dynamic model of household decision-making where parents allocate time across work, leisure, active time with the child, and child expenditures. These choices build a parent–child bond, a stock of relational capital which captures emotional warmth and consistency between the parent and child. I find that investment raises skill by strengthening the bond, with little direct effect on skill once the bond is accounted for. I also find that mothers’ active time is the most productive input into investment, followed by fathers’ active time and then expenditures on the child. In counterfactual analysis, I show that policies that raise family income, such as an income transfer, have little effect on the child’s skill, because parents spend the freed resources mostly on consumption and leisure. Next, I show that policies that could strengthen or change how parents value the parent–child bond, such as a parenting program, could be more effective than income transfers in improving child socio-emotional skill. These findings place the parent–child bond, rather than investment itself, at the centre of the technology of socio-emotional skill formation.

WORKING PAPERS

“Human Capital Development of Socio-Emotional Skills in Children” Sep 2026

Best Third-Year Research Paper Award; CRDCN Award & Webinar; SSHRC Doctoral Award

“Persistent Inequality in Maternal Mental Health” Jan 2025

With Fernando Saltiel

WORKS IN PROGRESS

“Parenting Style and Multidimensional Skills”

With Kentaro Asai

REPORTS

“Did the Pandemic and Current Labour Shortages Change the Quality of Jobs?” Jun 2024

With Mahmut Ablay, Luc Bissonnette, and Fabian Lange

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, McGill University 2023

Supervisor: Prof. Fabian Lange

Research Assistant, Queen’s & Carleton University 2022

Supervisors: Prof. James MacKinnon, Prof. Matt Webb, Prof. Morten Ørregaard Nielsen

Research Assistant (Computer Science), Carleton University 2022

APEX Group

Research Assistant, University of Calgary (PatiML) 2020

Supervisor: Prof. Alexander Whalley

WORK EXPERIENCE

Junior Data Science Analyst 2021–2022

Infrastructure Canada

Data Analyst, Data Science (Internship) 2021

Infrastructure Canada

Data Scientist (Internship) 2020

Critical Mass

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

McGill University 2022 – Present

Teaching Assistant

Introductory Econometrics
Introductory Microeconomics
Introductory Macroeconomics
Economic Statistics
Game Theory

Carleton University 2020 – 2022

Teaching Assistant

Graduate Economic Data Science
Graduate Macroeconomics
Applied Data Analysis

CONFERENCE & SEMINAR PRESENTATIONS

Royal Economic Society Conference (2026); Canadian Economics Association 60th Annual Conference (2026); 20th CIREQ-CIRANO Ph.D. Students' Conference (2026); CRDCN Emerging Scholars Webinar (2025); Canadian Economics Association 59th Annual Conference (2025); "Artificial Intelligence in Economics," Expanding Economics & McGill AI Society (2024)

SERVICE

President, McGill Economics Graduate Society (2024–present); Ph.D. Representative, CIREQ (2024–present); Co-President, Carleton Graduate Economics Society (2021–2022); Varsity Athlete, University of Calgary (2016–2018)

HONORS, SCHOLARSHIPS, AND FELLOWSHIPS

CRDCN Emerging Scholar Award (\$1,200)	2025
Best Third-Year Research Paper Award, McGill University	2025
SSHRC Doctoral Fellowship (\$80,000)	2025
Graduate Excellence Award in Economics (5-year Ph.D. funding)	2022
Ontario Graduate Scholarship (Declined, \$15,000)	2022
Randall Geehan Memorial Scholarship in Quantitative Economics (\$1,200)	2022
Departmental Merit Scholarship, Carleton University	2020
Dean's List, University of Calgary	2020
University of Calgary Faculty of Science IDEAS Fund Award	2020
Jason Lang Scholarship, University of Calgary	2019
Alexander Rutherford Scholarship, Government of Alberta	2016

REFERENCES

Placement Directors

Prof. Rui Castro

Department of Economics, McGill University
rui.castro@mcgill.ca

Prof. Kensuke Sakamoto

Department of Economics, McGill University
kensuke.sakamoto@mcgill.ca

Reference Letters

Prof. Fabian Lange

Department of Economics, McGill University
fabian.lange@mcgill.ca

Prof. Fernando Saltiel

Department of Economics, McGill University
fernando.saltiel@mcgill.ca

Prof. Nicolas Gendron-Carrier

Department of Economics, McGill University
nicolas.gendron-carrier@mcgill.ca

PROGRAMMING SKILLS

Python, R, Stata, SQL, Bash/Unix/Linux, Git, Matlab, Julia; Docker, PostGIS/RDBMS, LaTeX

LANGUAGES

English (Native), French (Intermediate)